

What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **Apple sued OpenAI** and one of its top executives, alleging the AI company stole trade secrets as part of its effort to develop competing devices. **A1**
- ◆ **SK Hynix soared 13%** in its U.S. debut as the South Korean chip maker pulled off a \$26.5 billion U.S. share sale, the largest ever by a foreign company. For the week, the S&P 500 and Nasdaq rose 1.2% and 1.7%, respectively, while the Dow fell 0.5%. **B10**
- ◆ **Meta Platforms** isn't doing enough to protect users' physical and mental health from its addictive designs of Instagram and Facebook, the EU said, escalating a probe that could yield heavy fines. **B9**
- ◆ **Private-equity firm** Warburg Pincus is near a deal to buy specialty-pharmacy company Pantherx Rare for over \$7 billion, including debt. **B9**
- ◆ **Delta said customers** aren't shrinking away from higher flight prices that have helped offset sky-high fuel costs after reporting a second-quarter surge in revenue. **B9**
- ◆ **MGM Resorts** has been negotiating a deal with Barry Diller's People Incorporated that would value the casino giant at \$12.4 billion. **B9**
- ◆ **The housing market** has been in a lengthy slump, but sales are showing signs of picking up this summer. **A2**

Worldwide

- ◆ **For four years**, Russia has bet on outlasting Ukraine in a war of attrition, but as Kyiv's drones inflict growing damage on both Russian's army and oil industry, Moscow is finding out that time isn't necessarily on its side. **A6**
- ◆ **A lack of defensive** capabilities aboard Trump's new luxury jet led him to fly home from his recent Turkey trip on an older Air Force One. **A4**
- ◆ **The Trump administration** believes that a nuclear deal with Iran is growing increasingly unlikely, senior officials said, a rare acknowledgment that one of the president's core foreign policy goals of capping Tehran's nuclear program might not be achievable through peace talks. **A6**
- ◆ **A Mexican immigrant** who was fatally shot by an immigration officer in Texas during a traffic stop wasn't the actual target of the operation, according to a U.S. congresswoman. **A2**
- ◆ **The U.S. and Canada** struck a deal that paves the way to open a new multibillion-dollar bridge between Detroit and Windsor, Ontario, resolving a trade irritant. **A5**
- ◆ **A Boeing 737 aircraft** made an emergency landing in Greece after an engine issue and dislodged window depressurized the cabin, pulling a passenger's head through the opening. **A7**

OPINION

Roland Fryer:
The economics of friendship. **A13**

CONTENTS	
Obituaries.....	C6
Books.....	C7-12
Business & Finance.....	B9
Sports.....	A11-13
Food.....	D6-7
Style & Fashion.....	D2,4
From Page One.....	A9
Travel.....	D8-9
Heard on Street.....	B12
U.S. News.....	A2-5
Markets.....	B10
World News.....	A6-8



Mooove Out of the Way for Famed Bull Run



CHARGE! Bulls barrel through the streets of Pamplona, Spain, on Friday during the annual San Fermín Festival, which draws thousands of visitors. It was featured in Ernest Hemingway's 'The Sun Also Rises,' which marks its 100th anniversary this year.

Democrats' Financial Problems Amp Up Pressure on Party Head

WASHINGTON—Ken Martin took over the Democratic National Committee promising to

By Sabrina Siddiqui,
Anthony DeBarros
and Lindsay Wise

rebuild the party from the grassroots up—pulling power out of Washington and into all 50 states.

More than a year later, Martin's DNC is struggling. The committee has had difficulty filling its coffers as Republicans amass a 2-to-1 cash edge, and as Democrats wage battle for the soul of the party, their national chairman has yet to emerge as a central player.

The predicament is in part Martin's own making, according to more than a dozen Dem-

ocratic operatives. From the start, Martin made clear he wasn't focused on repairing relationships with the major donors and party officials who hadn't backed his bid to run the committee. If those power brokers needed the DNC, he told allies, they could come to him.

That approach has come at a cost, just as the party's troubles mount: Its Senate nomi-

nee in Maine is being driven from the race in a scandal, and Democratic socialist candidates are knocking off established Democrats in primaries.

Against that backdrop, Martin faces growing criticism from some in the party who have said he has failed to broaden the committee's fundraising operation as Republi-

Please turn to page A4

Volkswagen's Vast Jobs Empire Faces an Unprecedented Threat

By Stephen Wilmot

For decades, Volkswagen's prowess in selling German-engineered cars around the world helped support a growing army of some of the auto industry's best-paid workers back home.

Now, that once-unshakeable business model—and the vast workforce it sustained—is under threat like never before.

The world's second-largest automaker said on Thursday it would cut its lineup of cars by as much as a half and further reduce its production capacity as part of its second major overhaul in under two years. "The cost reductions

planned to date under the agreed programs are not sufficient in the current economic and geopolitical environment," Chief Financial Officer Arno Antlitz said.

Volkswagen is facing challenges on multiple fronts. Chinese electric vehicles have eroded its business in China, which for years subsidized operations back home. Chinese brands are now making inroads into Volkswagen's European heartlands, and President Trump's tariffs have added billions of dollars in costs to its

Please turn to page A8

◆ **China market woes squeeze VW and BMW**..... **B10**

Cars sold in 2025 per employee

Toyota*	28 cars
Ford	26
GM	25
Stellantis	22
BMW	16
VW	14
Mercedes-Benz	13

*Toyota data for year through March 2026
Source: the companies

It Smells Like Rotting Flesh— And People Line Up for a Whiff

* * *

Corpse flowers can take years to bloom, but when they do it's an olfactory event

By Sanai Hadiya Rashid

During a typical summer week, the University of Rhode Island's greenhouse might draw 10 to 20 people.

When Jill Parrett showed up around midnight on a recent Wednesday, she was visitor number 3,744 of the day. After a four-hour wait, she finally got to see a blooming flower named Morticia. And catch a whiff.

It smelled like "a hint of dumpster at a seafood restaurant," said Parrett, 46, who visited with her husband and

two teenage kids.

The Woonsocket, R.I., resident was lucky. Greenhouse workers knew their corpse flower would soon bloom, unleashing its infamous stench only briefly, but they couldn't pinpoint when. This meant locals eager for a sniff were juggling schedules and watching for updates. Some didn't make it in time.

The school racked up nearly 650,000 YouTube views from people scanning a live feed of the towering plant. Parrett was among viewers

Please turn to page A9

EXCHANGE



A TEXAS-SIZED BET
The state is rustling up business as trading starts on its new stock exchange. **B1**

How Norway Created A World Cup Monster

By Ben Cohen
and Joshua Robinson

When a group of boys from a small town on the coast of Norway began playing for the same youth soccer club, there was no way of knowing where any of them would end up in 20 years.

The club was free and open to everyone. The teams cared more about having fun than winning—and barely kept score. Inside a small dome where they could practice year-round, through Scandinavian winters and darkness, the kids of Bryne FK played without pressure. Their volunteer coaches preached a simple

philosophy: "As many as possible, for as long as possible, and as good as possible."

In other words, the least American way possible.

But unlike the American method of raising soccer talent, this one actually worked. Of the 40 boys on that club team, 35 kept playing from childhood through adulthood. Six turned pro. Five were selected for youth national teams.

And one grew up to be the most intimidating soccer player in the entire world.

When Norway stares down England on Saturday with the hopes of rowing into the World Cup semifinals for the

Please turn to page A10